# The workplan

*What exactly will we investigate, with which evidence, and by when?*



# Today

By the end of today, you will have

**Built a workplan linking each priority hypothesis to an analysis, a source and a deadline, opened your evidence register, and submitted Gate 2.**

- Turn each priority hypothesis into a research question.
- Link each question to an analysis, a named source and a deadline.
- Identify evidence gaps and decide how to handle them.
- Open the evidence register.

**Competencies: E1 · E2**

Session plan

| | |
|---|---|
| 10 min | **Opening problem** |
| 10 min | **Concept: from register to workplan** |
| 15 min | **Demonstration: Madhyapur workplan** |
| 25 min | **Activity: missing data challenge** |
| 40 min | **Gate 2: pod peer review** |
| 20 min | **Debrief and planning** |

# Opening problem

- **Your register has five hypotheses and you have about fifteen hours left. Which analysis would most change your recommendation if it came out the other way?**

That analysis goes first in your workplan.

# The workplan matrix: Madhyapur

| Hypothesis | Research question | Analysis | Source | By |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **H1 contract** | Do crews mix more under payment by weight? | Compare cities with different payment terms | Published contracts, audit and committee reports, city case studies | Day 13 |
| **H2 containers** | Is separation higher where bins were given out? | Compare wards before and after distribution | Corporation records (illustrative), city reports | Day 12 |
| **H3 processing** | Is separated waste processed separately? | Set processing capacity against waste generated | The city's waste management plan; pollution control board reports | Day 12 |
| **H4 enforcement** | Do fines raise separation or dumping? | Compare wards with and without enforcement drives | Corporation records, news reports | Day 13 |

Each row is a promise: one question, one analysis, one source, one date.

# Three questions before you commit to a source

1

## Does it cover my place and period?

A state-level survey cannot answer a ward-level question. Check the level and the year.

2

## How was it produced?

Survey, administrative record, audit, study or report: each has typical strengths and biases.

3

## Can I get it in time?

A source you cannot access in four weeks belongs in the limitations, not the workplan.

# Evidence gaps: name them, do not hide them

| Gap | Why it exists | How to handle it |
|---|---|---|
| **No ward-level data on separation** | Not published | Use city figures and comparable cities; state the limitation |
| **No direct evidence of crew behaviour** | No observation in this course | Use audit findings, published studies and credible reporting |
| **Contract terms not public** | Commercial confidentiality | Use tender documents, model contracts and other cities' published terms |

There is no primary research in this course. Gaps are filled from published sources or stated as limitations.

# The evidence register opens today

| Field | What to record |
|---|---|
| **Citation** | Full reference in Chicago style |
| **Type** | Official data, audit, parliamentary, research, journalism |
| **Coverage** | Place, period and level |
| **Method** | How it was produced |
| **Reliability** | High, medium or low, with a reason |
| **Supports or weakens** | Which hypothesis, and in which direction |
| **Verified** | Checked against the original: yes or no |
| **AI used** | Whether an AI tool helped find or summarise it |

The register carries 15 per cent of the marks and is assessed with the final report.

# Activity: The missing data challenge

Design a feasible research plan when the ideal data do not exist.

**Scenario**

A state wants to know why wage payments under the rural employment guarantee reach some workers late in a stylised district. You have four weeks, no field access and only published sources. Assume you cannot obtain worker-level payment records with reasons for delay in that time.

**What to do**

1. Write down the ideal dataset you would want.
2. List published sources that could stand in for it, such as scheme reports, audits and studies.
3. For each, note what it can and cannot tell you.
4. Choose the two analyses that would most change the answer.
5. Write the limitation you would state in the final report.

**Time** 25 minutes

**Groups** Pods of four

**Output** A two-analysis plan with stated limitations

# Gate 2 pod peer review: 40 minutes

1

## Swap

Each member reviews another member's Gate 2 submission.

2

## Check

Use the Gate 2 rubric: institutions, priorities, hypotheses and workplan.

3

## Write

One strength, one critical weakness, one required revision.

4

## Discuss

Eight minutes per case, led by the chair.

5

## Revise

Make at least one change before you submit tonight.

This week's roles have rotated: check who is chair, sceptic, evidence checker and scribe.

# Your case: Worksheet 4.3

## Workplan and evidence register

1. Turn each priority hypothesis into a research question.
2. For each, name the analysis, the source and the day by which it will be done.
3. List your evidence gaps and how you will handle each.
4. Open your evidence register with at least three sources.
5. Submit Gate 2 with a revision note and AI disclosure.

### Hand in

Gate 2 (Worksheets 3.1, 3.2, 4.1, 4.2 and 4.3, revised) by the end of Day 10. Feedback returned by Day 12.

### Quality check

Every priority hypothesis has a question, analysis, source and date.

Tag every claim in your Analyst's Ledger: fact, inference, assumption or hypothesis.

# What to take away

1. A workplan turns hypotheses into promises: question, analysis, source, date.
2. Check level, period and access before you commit to a source.
3. Name evidence gaps and say how you will handle them.
4. Keep the evidence register as you go; it is assessed.

**Exit task** Write the date by which your first analysis will be done.

# Before the next session

### Independent work

Rest, then start the first analysis in your workplan. About 30 minutes.

### Read

The methods note or data documentation for the main dataset in your workplan: read how it was collected and at what level it is representative.

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### Next

## Day 11: Finding and judging evidence

Week 3 begins with finding and judging evidence in the Indian data ecosystem.